

Given below is a command that will allow others to access your Web application using the browser. All you need to do is run the following command in the terminal from the folder where you have kept the files.

```
alias webshare='python -c "import SimpleHTTPServer;SimpleHTTPServer.test()"'
```

Now just run *webshare* and the current directory and everything beneath it will be served from a new Web server listening on Port 8000. To stop access, you need to hit *Control+c*.

After running the *webshare*, anyone on the network can access it using the following command:

```
http://[your-ip-here]:8000
```

— Saravanan Arumugam,
saravananarumugam.1989@gmail.com

View history without line numbers

When we need to know which command we ran previously, we use the *History* command. But, by default, this gives you all your previous commands with line numbers. *History* is one of the most frequently used commands by systems administrators. Sometimes we need to copy-paste or store these commands into a file. But when we do this, we have to manually remove those line numbers and this becomes rather annoying.

Here is a simple trick that will remove line numbers from the command list. All you need to do is pipe the *History* command with the *Cut* command.

```
[bash]$ history | cut -c 8-
```

history, shows the history of commands
|, pipes two commands
cut, removes sections from each line of the files
-c, will select only certain characters
N-, will show the output from the Nth byte, character or field, to the end of the line. In this case, the bash history command shows the actual command from the 8th character.

And if you want to store this list into the file, use the following command:

```
[bash]$ history | cut -c 8- > <filename>
```

— Lokesh Kumar Pawar,
lokeshpavaruit@gmail.com

Automatically correct mistyped directory names

We can use *shopt -s cdspell* to correct the typos in the *cd*

command automatically as shown below. If you are not good at typing and make a lot of mistakes, this will be very helpful.

```
# cd /etc/mall  
-bash: cd: /etc/mall: No such file or directory
```

Now, run the following command. This will turn on auto-correction when you mistype the name of a directory.

```
# shopt -s cdspell  
# cd /etc/mall  
  
# pwd  
  
/etc/mail
```

Note: By mistake, when I typed *mall* instead of *mail*, *cd* corrected it automatically.

— Rajeeb Senapati,
rajeeb.koomar@gmail.com

Check open ports

Generally, when doing systems administration, port handling is somewhat crucial. Systems administrators maintaining a firewall must always know which ports are open on a given machine, to avoid security issues.

Just a simple trick does it all – to know whether a port is open on the remote machine, run the command below:

```
echo > /dev/tcp/{ip-address}/{port} && echo "open"
```

Example:

```
echo > /dev/tcp/74.125.130.102/80 && echo "open"
```

If the output is open, the port is open; otherwise not.

— Manish Jain,
manish.msiclub@gmail.com



Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.